

Whipped Ricotta with Honey and Walnuts (Variation 16)

Tags: snack, vegetarian, quick, appetiser, gluten-free | Prep: 10 min | Cook: 0 min | Serves: 3

Ingredients

- 250 g full-fat ricotta
- 30 g cream cheese, softened
- 1 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 0.5/2 tsp fine salt
- Zest of 0.5 lemon
- topping: 1.5 tbsp good honey, 60 g walnuts toasted and roughly chopped, fresh rosemary leaves, extra olive oil, black pepper, flaky sea salt
- Crostini or sourdough to serve

Method

1. Drain ricotta in a fine-mesh sieve for 15 minutes if it looks watery.
2. Place ricotta, cream cheese, olive oil, salt, and lemon zest in a food processor.
3. Process for 2–3 minutes until completely smooth, pale, and airy.
4. Taste and adjust salt and lemon.
5. Transfer to a serving bowl. Use the back of a spoon to create swoops and divots.
6. Drizzle with honey. Scatter walnuts, fresh thyme, and a pinch of flaky salt.
7. Drizzle with extra olive oil and crack over black pepper.
8. Serve immediately with crostini or sourdough toasts.

Chef Tips

- Full-fat ricotta is essential — low-fat versions are too watery and won't whip properly.
- Processing for 2+ minutes transforms the grainy texture into something incredibly silky.
- The combination of good honey and flaky salt is what makes this simple dish sing.